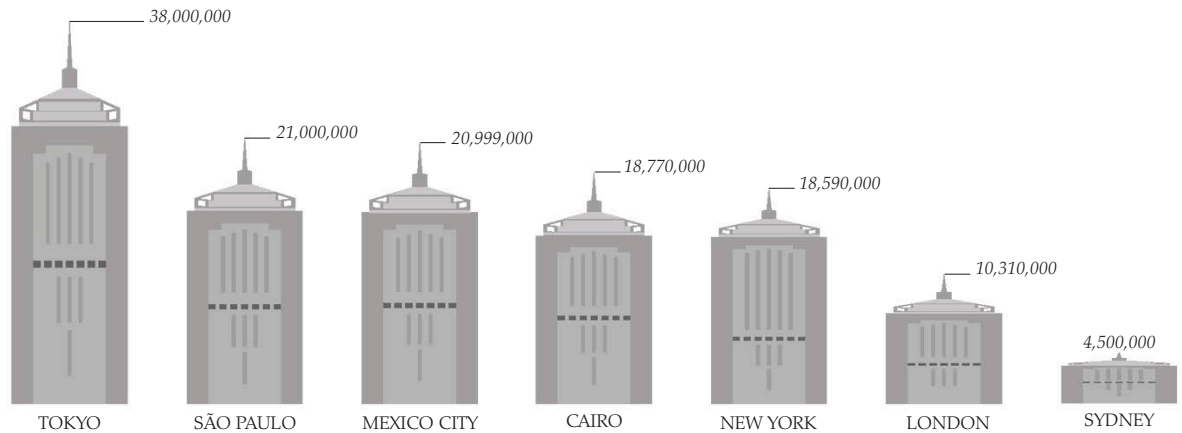


CITY POPULATIONS

As populations grow, people tend to move from the country to a city to find work. Today, one-third of the world's people live in cities, which grow bigger every year. Some are colossal, like Tokyo—the largest city in Asia. The other cities shown here are the most populous on each continent. They are vibrant centers of civilization, but some cities are fringed by sprawling shantytowns, where poor people live in makeshift shacks with no proper services such as clean water.



LANGUAGES

These are the 10 most common languages worldwide, sized in proportion to the number of native speakers. Chinese outstrips the others because China has such a huge population. But Spanish comes next because it is the main language of many Latin American countries, such as Mexico. English is almost as common, thanks mainly to being the language of the United States. It is also used as an international language for trade.



Christianity
2.2 billion

Islam
1.6 billion

Hinduism
1 billion

Buddhism
487 million

Chinese traditional
300 million

Indigenous
300 million

African traditional
100 million

Others
97.7 million

Others	
Sikhism	23 million
Juche	19 million
Spiritism	15 million
Judaism	14 million
Baha'i	7 million
Jainism	4.2 million
Shinto	4 million
Cao Đài	4 million
Zoroastrianism	2.6 million
Tenrikyo	2 million
Neo-Paganism	1 million
Unitarian	
Universalism	800,000
Rastafarianism	600,000
Scientology	500,000

RELIGIONS AND BELIEFS

Almost three-quarters of the world's population are followers of Christianity, Islam, Hinduism, or Buddhism. But many people follow other faiths, particularly in China where the traditional folk religion, Shenism, is practised by nearly one-fifth of the huge population. The "indigenous" and "African traditional religions" data points are both groupings of different, but similar, religions. Others are listed at far right, in order of popularity.

ONLINE ACCESS

Over the last decades, the Internet has become a vital tool for global business, education, and politics, so the more people who can use it, the better. These charts show the percentage of people with Internet access both worldwide and in particular regions. Australia, North America, and Europe lead the field, but the number of Internet users is growing fastest in the Middle East and Africa.

